# Rylan Stalnaker

SOC Analyst | Security Operations | SIEM & Incident Analysis
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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Entry-level SOC Analyst with hands-on experience in threat detection, alert triage, log analysis, and incident investigation using Wazuh SIEM across Windows and Linux endpoints. Designed and deployed a home lab simulating real-world attack scenarios — including brute-force authentication, privilege escalation, and defense evasion — and documented findings in structured incident reports aligned with NIST SP 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK. Holds a B.S. in Cybersecurity and Information Assurance (WGU) with a CompTIA certification stack including CySA+ and Security+. Focused on accurate triage, false positive reduction, and clear, audit-ready documentation.

## CYBERSECURITY PROJECTS

**SIEM Security Monitoring Lab — WGU Capstone** 2025 – Present
*Independent Project*

- Deployed a centralized Wazuh SIEM on Ubuntu Server with Windows and Linux endpoints on an isolated NAT virtual network, simulating a small enterprise SOC environment.
- Simulated and detected attack scenarios mapped to MITRE ATT&CK: brute-force authentication (T1110.001), new account creation and privilege escalation (T1136.001, T1098), firewall disablement via Set-NetFirewallProfile (T1562.004), and file permission modification (T1222.002).
- Performed alert triage and log analysis in the Wazuh Dashboard; correlated alerts to Windows Security Event IDs (4624, 4625, 4720, 4732) and Wazuh rule IDs to identify indicators of compromise.
- Documented findings in a structured incident report following NIST SP 800-61 Rev. 2 phases: Detection & Analysis, Containment, Eradication, Recovery, and Post-Incident Activity.
- Identified false positive patterns and documented detection tuning recommendations based on simulated attack behavior.

**Active Directory User Management Lab** 2025
*Independent Project*

- Built and configured Windows Server 2019 Active Directory with DNS, DHCP, and NAT/RRAS in a virtualized environment to simulate enterprise identity and access management.
- Automated provisioning of 1,000+ domain accounts using PowerShell, enforcing naming standards and group membership policies.

**TryHackMe — SOC Level 1 & Security Labs** 2024 – Present
*Independent Study*

- Completed 10+ structured labs across offensive tooling and web fundamentals; each write-up documents investigation methodology, evidence, and defensive takeaways aligned to SOC analyst workflows.
- Actively progressing through SOC Level 1 path with focus on network analysis, phishing investigation, and Windows Event Log analysis.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**VR Contract Employment — American Indian Resource Center, Tahlequah OK** May 2026 – June 2026

- Set up school accounts for VR headsets and implemented headsets into local rural schools.
- Created a complete training program to train teachers on the headsets along with creating documents outlining different applications, their uses, and what subjects they could be used for in different curriculum. Along with creating a detailed document to help the school train future teachers to help them be self-sufficient after my contract ends along with how to troubleshoot the headsets.
- Was the main point-of-contact for any other issues that arise for the rest of the contract time period.

**Accounting Associate — Cherokee Nation Entertainment, Tahlequah OK** Oct 2023 – Aug 2024

- Identified and corrected data discrepancies through systematic record review, demonstrating the analytical attention to detail required for alert triage and incident documentation.
- Collaborated cross-functionally to meet strict monthly closing deadlines, demonstrating reliability in structured, process-driven workflows.

**Call Support Specialist — Provalus, Tahlequah OK** Jun 2023 – Oct 2023

- Investigated and resolved system and network issues by analyzing logs and system behavior to identify root causes — directly applicable to SOC triage and incident analysis.
- Documented technical incidents and resolutions in a repeatable format to support consistent troubleshooting and knowledge sharing.

**IT Help Desk Technician — Fort Lewis College, Durango CO** Aug 2021 – Jun 2022

- Provided technical support across Windows and Linux environments; escalated complex cases and documented resolutions to enable efficient knowledge transfer.

**VR Lab Specialist — American Indian Resource Center, Tahlequah OK** May 2020 – Jun 2023

- Implemented and maintained security protocols within the lab environment to ensure data protection and system integrity.

## CORE SKILLS

**Security Operations:** SIEM (Wazuh, Splunk), alert triage & incident investigation, log analysis & correlation, threat detection & analysis, false positive reduction, detection tuning

**Frameworks & Standards:** NIST SP 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK (technique & sub-technique mapping), incident response lifecycle

**Endpoint & Cloud:** Windows Event Logs, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (foundational), Linux security monitoring, Azure (in progress)

**Systems & Networking:** Active Directory, DNS, DHCP, TCP/IP, Windows Server 2019, Ubuntu Linux

**Scripting:** PowerShell (automation, user provisioning), basic Python

**Tools:** Wazuh, Splunk, Nmap, Metasploit, Wireshark, Hydra, Gobuster, Burp Suite

**Documentation:** NIST-aligned incident reports, SOC-style investigation write-ups, audit-ready ticket documentation

## EDUCATION

**B.S. Cybersecurity and Information Assurance — Western Governors University** (Aug 2023 – Mar 2026)

## CERTIFICATIONS

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|---|---|
| CompTIA CySA+ | 09/2025 – 09/2031 |
| CompTIA Security Analytics Professional | 09/2025 – 09/2031 |
| CompTIA PenTest+ | 01/2026 – 01/2029 |
| CompTIA Network Vulnerability Assessment Professional | 01/2026 – 01/2029 |
| CompTIA Network Security Professional | 01/2026 – 01/2029 |
| CompTIA Security+ | 06/2024 – 09/2031 |
| CompTIA Secure Infrastructure Specialist | 06/2024 – 09/2031 |
| CompTIA Network+ | 01/2024 – 09/2031 |
| CompTIA IT Operations Specialist | 01/2024 – 09/2031 |
| CompTIA A+ | 09/2023 – 09/2031 |
| Associate of ISC2 (SSCP) | 02/2025 – 02/2027 |
| ITIL 4 Foundation | 09/2024 – 09/2027 |
| CompTIA Project+ (PK0-005) | 07/2025 |
| Linux Essentials | 12/2024 |

## PROFESSIONAL ASSOCIATIONS

ISC2 Member